PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Jeep Grand Wagoneer (SJ)

1984–1991 · SJ · Grand Wagoneer

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust first, everything else second**
  Hagerty's buyer's guide calls rust the biggest concern. Lift the front carpet to see the floor pans, then check where the fuel tank meets the body, the underbody and frame, and the front fenders near the parking lamps. New fenders are no longer available. YourMechanic adds the frame near the fuel-tank skid plate and the rockers, and says the driver's floor is the most common hole.
- [ ] **Bubbles under the woodgrain**
  The wood is vinyl. Bubbles under it usually mean rust working from the inside. Replacement Cherry Oak and Marine Teak (1987–91) vinyl kits exist, but the metal underneath has to be fixed first.
- [ ] **Drive it cold and hot**
  Kerr estimates the Motorcraft carburetor causes about 40% of owner headaches. Stumbling or stalling cold or hot is common. Also listen for ignition faults and watch the oil-pressure gauge. A rear main seal leak costs $500–1,000 to fix.
- [ ] **Test 4WD on the move**
  Selec-Trac should engage on the fly. Check that 4WD engages and disengages properly and shift through every range; low range can grind. Look for leaking transfer-case seals.
- [ ] **Work every switch**
  Window flex tracks snap, and window and power-lock switches fail often. The rear-window switch frequently dies, and because the glass must come down to reach the inside tailgate handle, a dead switch can lock you out of the tailgate.
- [ ] **Check the A/C and the cabin**
  A/C repairs are expensive. The 1989–91 trucks got a better compressor than the earlier leak-prone one. Sagging headliners and water-damaged door panels are common.
- [ ] **Know the year**
  Wikipedia points to 1989–91 for better rustproofing, paint and equipment, and a 1991 Final Edition commands a premium. Hagerty says tan or sand interiors and blue, green or white paint sell best.
- [ ] **Ask where it lived**
  Kerr won't buy trucks from road-salt states and estimates about 20% of needed parts have to come from salvage yards. A dry-state truck with a known history is worth paying for.

YEARS TO KNOW

1989	SWEET SPOT	Start of the 'best of the breed' run: more reliable A/C compressor, rear wiper/washer, minivan-sourced overhead console with compass and thermometer, keyless entry, electrocoat primer and base/clear paint, gunmetal wheel inlays
1991	SWEET SPOT	Final year of the 1989–91 'best of the breed' run; buyers after the February 27 discontinuation announcement could add a gold 'Final Edition' dash badge, and Hagerty says low-mileage examples are desirable and expensive. Last truck built June 21, 1991

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Front wheel bearing lubrication**
  1984 · NHTSA 84V-009
- ☐ **Contaminated brake fluid**
  1986 · NHTSA 85V-140
- ☐ **Cruise-control module**
  1987 · NHTSA 87V-022
- ☐ **Key-operated tailgate window**
  1984–1988 · NHTSA 87V-178

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **SJ Grand Wagoneer vs XJ Wagoneer**
  The 1984–90 XJ Wagoneer and Wagoneer Limited are compact unibody Cherokees with woodgrain; the Grand Wagoneer is the body-on-frame SJ on a 108.7 in wheelbase with a 6-lug 15×7 wheel. The 1993 Grand Wagoneer is a ZJ Grand Cherokee.
- ☐ **VIN**
  Characters 6–7 read 15 on a Grand Wagoneer. On 1984–86 VINs the 4th character is the engine (C = 258 six, N = 360 V8); on 1987–90 VINs N = 5.9 V8, the only engine offered. The 10th character is the model year.
- ☐ **1989–91 tells**
  Rear wiper/washer, overhead console with compass and outside temperature, infrared keyless entry, and alloy wheels with gunmetal-grey inlays instead of the earlier gold.
- ☐ **1986-on interior**
  Square-gauge dash, two-spoke steering wheel, plastic woodgrain glovebox door and adjustable front head restraints mark a 1986 or later truck; earlier trucks have the old dash and metal glovebox door.
- ☐ **Final Edition badge**
  The gold 'Final Edition' dash badge was a 1991-only option for trucks sold after February 27, 1991, so one on any earlier year was added later.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/jeep/grand-wagoneer/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks